UPSC INDIAN POLITY

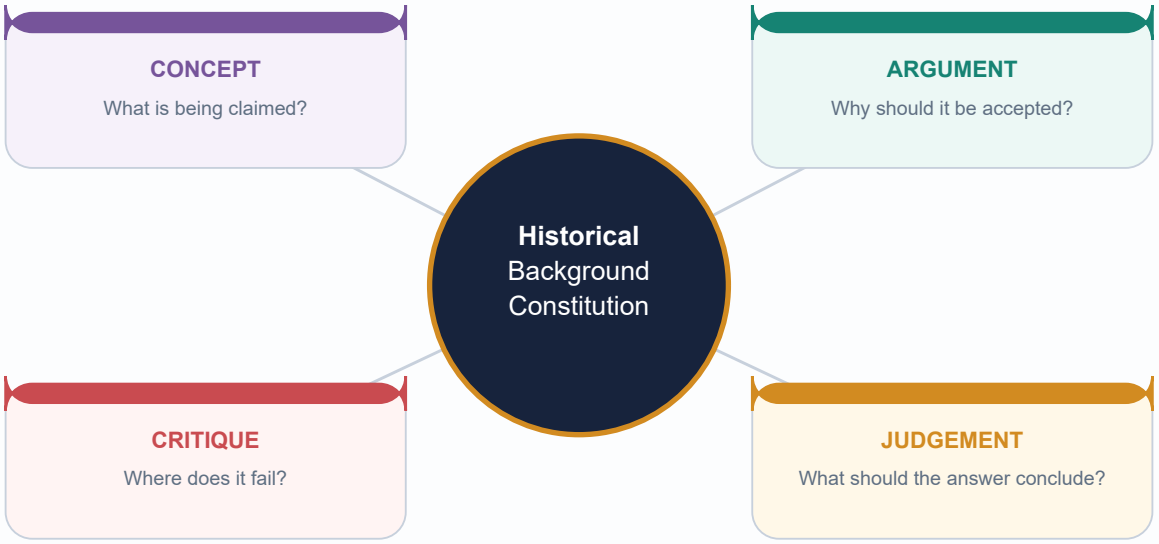
# Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains

Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth

Sources: Historical-Background.md + 01_Historical-Background.md

Learning cards: 53




Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

## HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

# Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

**Subject:** Polity · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS Paper:** GS-I / GS-II

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

**Core Foundation**

V

| | |
|---|---|
| **Dimension 1**<br>Subject: Polity · Tier: Basic (foundation) · GS Paper: GS-I / GS-II | **Dimension 2**<br>Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant (Ch. 1) |
| **Dimension 3**<br>□ = from source book · □□ = inference / standard knowledge | |

### STATIC THEORY

- **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant (Ch. 1)

- □ = from source book · □□ = inference / standard knowledge

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1.** = from source book · □□ = inference / standard knowledge

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

# Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

### KEY DATA

| Item | Detail |
|---|---|
| Company arrives | □ 1600 (East India Company; charter of **Queen Elizabeth I**) |
| Diwani of Bengal/Bihar/Orissa | □ 1765 → territorial power |
| Crown takes over | □ 1858 (after Revolt of 1857) |
| Independence | □ 15 Aug 1947 |
| Two phases | □ Company Rule (1773–1858) · Crown Rule (1858–1947) |

**MAINS ANGLE**

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

## Foundation · Core idea

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

 Many features of our Constitution have **roots in British-era laws**. A chain of Acts built the legal framework of government in India — the most important being the **Government of India Act, 1935** (the biggest source of the present Constitution).

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1.** Many features of our Constitution have **roots in British-era laws**. A chain of Acts built the legal framework of government in India — the most important being the **Government of India Act, 1935** (the biggest source of the present Constitution).

**MAINS ANGLE**

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

## Foundation · Company Rule — key Acts

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

### KEY DATA

| Act | Landmark |
|---|---|
|  Regulating Act **1773** | GG of **Bengal** (Warren Hastings); Supreme Court Calcutta |
|  Pitt's India Act **1784** | Board of Control → **double government** |
|  Charter Act **1813** | Ended Company trade monopoly (except tea/China) |
|  Charter Act **1833** | GG of **India** (William Bentinck); centralisation |
|  Charter Act **1853** | Separated legislative & executive; open competition for civil service |

**MAINS ANGLE**

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Company Rule — key Acts

HIGH

# Foundation · Crown Rule — key Acts

GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

## KEY DATA

| Act | Landmark |
|---|---|
| □ GoI Act **1858** | Abolished Company; **Viceroy** (Canning); Secretary of State |
| □ Councils Act **1861** | Indians in law-making; portfolio system |
| □ Councils Act **1909** (Morley-Minto) | **Separate electorate for Muslims** (Minto = father of communal electorate) |
| □ GoI Act **1919** (Montagu-Chelmsford) | **Dyarchy** in provinces; bicameralism; direct elections |
| □ GoI Act **1935** | **Provincial autonomy**; federal scheme; RBI; Federal Court |
| □ Independence Act **1947** | Two dominions; end of British rule |

## MAINS ANGLE

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Crown Rule — key Acts

HIGH

# Foundation · Crown Rule — key Acts

GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Mnemonic (reforms pairs): **1909 = communal electorate · 1919 = dyarchy ·**

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

## STATIC THEORY

- **1935 = provincial autonomy**. (Don't swap them!)

## MEMORY HOOK

**Mnemonic (reforms pairs): 1909 = communal electorate · 1919 = dyarchy ·**

## MAINS ANGLE

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Crown Rule — key Acts

HIGH

## Foundation · Government of India Act, 1935 - complete Prelims core · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

### KEY DATA

| Feature | Exact distinction |
|---|---|
| **All-India Federation** | Proposed a federation of British Indian provinces and princely states |
| **Did the federation operate?** | **No.** Accession of the required princely states did not occur |
| **Provincial autonomy** | Dyarchy in provinces was abolished and responsible government expanded, subject to gubernatorial safeguards |
| **Dyarchy at the Centre** | Federal subjects were divided into reserved and transferred subjects, but this federal arrangement did not commence |
| **Reserved federal subjects** | **Defence, external/foreign affairs, ecclesiastical affairs and tribal areas** were administered by the Governor-General with councillors, not controlled by responsible ministers or the federal legislature |
| **Legislative lists** | Federal, Provincial and Concurrent Lists |
| **Residuary powers** | Vested in the Governor-General, not automatically in the federal or provincial legislature |
| **Bicameralism** | Introduced in six provinces |

### MAINS ANGLE

**STUDY LINK**

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Government of India Act, 1935 - complete Prelims core

HIGH

## Foundation · Government of India Act, 1935 - complete Prelims core · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

### KEY DATA

| Feature | Exact distinction |
|---|---|
| **Institutions** | Provided for the Federal Court; separated Burma; supported the institutional framework associated with the RBI |

**MAINS ANGLE**

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Government of India Act, 1935 - complete Prelims core

HIGH

## Foundation · Government of India Act, 1935 - complete Prelims core

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

**2024 Prelims trap:** The Act **provided** for an All-India Federation of provinces and princely

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ACT, 1935 - COMPLETE PRELIMS CORE: RECALL MAP

**Government of India Act, 1935 - complete Prelims core**

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|---|---|
| **Dimension 1**<br>2024 Prelims trap: The Act provided for an All-India Federation of provinces and princely | **Dimension 2**<br>states, so that statement is correct even though the federation never came into operation. |
| **Dimension 3**<br>Defence and foreign affairs were reserved under the Governor-General, not kept under the | **Dimension 4**<br>control of the federal legislature. Therefore, for that two-statement question, statement 1 |

### STATIC THEORY

- states, so that statement is correct even though the federation never came into operation.

- Defence and foreign affairs were **reserved under the Governor-General**, not kept under the

- control of the federal legislature. Therefore, for that two-statement question, **statement 1

- only** is correct.

**MAINS ANGLE**

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Government of India Act, 1935 - complete Prelims core

HIGH

## Foundation · Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

 First **GG of Bengal** = Warren Hastings (1773); first **GG of India** = William Bentinck (1833).

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

## MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS): RECALL MAP

**Must-Know Facts (Prelims)**

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| | |
|---|---|
| **Dimension 1**<br>□ First GG of Bengal = Warren Hastings (1773); first GG of India = William Bentinck (1833). | **Dimension 2**<br>□ First Viceroy = Lord Canning (1858). |
| **Dimension 3**<br>□ Separate electorate for Muslims = Councils Act 1909. | **Dimension 4**<br>□ Dyarchy in provinces = GoI Act 1919; abolished by 1935 (provincial autonomy). |

### STATIC THEORY

- □ First **Viceroy** = Lord Canning (1858).
- □ **Separate electorate for Muslims** = Councils Act **1909**.
- □ **Dyarchy** in provinces = GoI Act **1919**; abolished by **1935** (provincial autonomy).
- □ **GoI Act 1935** = 321 Sections, 10 Schedules; biggest source of the Constitution.
- □ **Poona Pact (1932)** followed the Communal Award (SC reserved seats, joint electorate).
- □□ Every Act's features, the "firsts" table, the Simon Commission, the Communal Award, the traps and the Mains angles are all held **in this file**. *Advanced: optional extended colonial-Acts narrative in advanced/01_Historical-Background.md — not required for any mark.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. First **GG of Bengal** = Warren Hastings (1773); first **GG of India** = William Bentinck (1833).
2. First **Viceroy** = Lord Canning (1858).
3. **Separate electorate for Muslims** = Councils Act **1909**.
4. **Dyarchy** in provinces = GoI Act **1919**; abolished by **1935** (provincial autonomy).
5. **GoI Act 1935** = 321 Sections, 10 Schedules; biggest source of the Constitution.
6. **Poona Pact (1932)** followed the Communal Award (SC reserved seats, joint electorate).

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

HIGH

## Foundation · Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support).

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

**MAINS ANGLE**

*Purpose: this chapter is asked as a **continuity / source-tracing** question, not as narration. This section supplies a strand-by-strand engine (centralisation vs devolution), an Act → 1950-feature map, and strict reform-pair discipline so no answer swaps 1909/1919/1935.*

**STUDY LINK**

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

HIGH

## Foundation · 7.1 Demand and directive map

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

### KEY DATA

| Demand family | Typical directive signals | Answer spine to use |
|---|---|---|
| Constitution as culmination of colonial law | "natural culmination", "Examine", "trace the roots" | Continuity thesis → centralisation strand → representative strand → 1935 as chief source → what was rejected |
| Source-tracing a specific feature | "Which Act introduced…", "origins of federalism/judiciary/services" | Name Act → its provision → the 1950 feature it seeded → caution |
| Evolution of representative institutions | "growth of representative government", 1861→1935 | 1861 non-officials → 1892 budget/questions → 1909 electorate → 1919 dyarchy → 1935 autonomy |
| Seeds of communalism / partition | "communal representation", "separate electorates" | 1909 electorate → 1919 extension → 1932 Communal Award → constitutional rejection |
| Centralisation vs devolution | "centralising tendency", compare phases | 1773–1833 centralise → 1861–1935 devolve → strong-Centre inheritance |
| Borrowed vs original | "merely borrowed", "how far original" | Structural continuity → indigenous additions (FR, DPSP, universal franchise) → balanced verdict |

**MAINS ANGLE**

**STUDY LINK**

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.1 Demand and directive map

HIGH

## Foundation · 7.2 Qualified thesis options

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

*The 1950 Constitution did not begin on a blank page: its administrative spine, federal scheme, public services and judiciary were inherited from a century of colonial statutes — above all the Government of India Act 1935 — while its democratic soul, universal franchise, justiciable rights and single citizenship, was a decisive Indian departure.*

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

## 7.2 QUALIFIED THESIS OPTIONS: RECALL MAP

**7.2 Qualified thesis options**

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|---|---|
| **Dimension 1**<br>The 1950 Constitution did not begin on a blank page: its administrative spine, federal scheme, public services and judiciary were inherited from a cen | **Dimension 2**<br>Constitutional development under Company and Crown moved in two opposite directions — relentless centralisation from 1773 to 1858 and cautious devolut |
| **Dimension 3**<br>The colonial reforms that most shaped 1950 matter as much for what the framers rejected — separate electorates, official majorities and gubernatorial | **Dimension 4**<br>If the 1935 Act is the Constitution's largest single quarry, the reforms of 1909–1932 are its cautionary text, showing how community-based representat |

### STATIC THEORY

- *Constitutional development under Company and Crown moved in two opposite directions — relentless centralisation from 1773 to 1858 and cautious devolution from 1861 to 1935 — and the Constitution inherited both, producing a federation with an unmistakable unitary bias.*

- *The colonial reforms that most shaped 1950 matter as much for what the framers rejected — separate electorates, official majorities and gubernatorial "reserved" powers — as for what they retained.*

- *If the 1935 Act is the Constitution's largest single quarry, the reforms of 1909–1932 are its cautionary text, showing how community-based representation, once conceded, hardened into a claim to nationhood.*

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.2 Qualified thesis options

HIGH

# Foundation · 7.3 Mark-scaled structures

**GS-II** Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

### KEY DATA

| Marks | Architecture | Evidence load |
|---|---|---|
| 10 | Continuity thesis → two strands (centralise + represent) → 1935 as chief source → one rejection → verdict | 3–4 named Acts |
| 15 | Thesis → centralisation strand → representative strand → Act→feature map → what was rejected → verdict | 6–7 Acts with seeded features |
| 20 | Thesis → structural continuity → representative evolution → federal origins → 1935 in detail → rejected features → indigenous additions → graded verdict | 250 words; 8–10 Acts + a "borrowed vs original" paragraph |

**MAINS ANGLE**

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.3 Mark-scaled structures

HIGH

# Foundation · 7.4 Bank A — Centralisation strand (the executive / administrative inheritance)

GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

**Claim:** a single, centralised executive and legislature were built incrementally. **Evidence:** □ Regulating Act **1773** made the Governor of Bengal the **Governor-General of Bengal** and subordinated Bombay & Madras; □ Charter Act **1833** created the **Governor-General of India** (first, Bentinck) with sole all-India legislative authority (laws now "Acts"). **Significance:** □□ antecedent of a single Union executive and law-making legislature. **Caution:** □ the GG of *India* dates from **1833**, not 1773.

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

## 7.4 BANK A — CENTRALISATION STRAND (THE EXECUTIVE / ADMINISTRATIVE INHERITANCE): RECALL MAP

**7.4 Bank A — Centralisation strand (the executive / administrative inheritance)**

V

| | |
|---|---|
| **Dimension 1**<br>Claim: a single, centralised executive and legislature were built incrementally. Evidence: □ Regulating Act 1773 made the Governor of Bengal the Gover | **Dimension 2**<br>Claim: civilian/political control over the administration predates independence. Evidence: □ Pitt's India Act 1784 created the Board of Control → "dou |
| **Dimension 3**<br>Claim: Crown sovereignty gave a unitary, centrally answerable top. Evidence: □ Charter Act 1813 asserted Crown sovereignty over Company territories; □ | |

## STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** civilian/political control over the administration predates independence. **Evidence:** □ Pitt's India Act **1784** created the **Board of Control** → "double government"; □ Charter Act **1793** entrenched the GG's power to override the council. **Significance:** □□ the principle that administration answers to a political authority foreshadows ministerial responsibility. **Caution:** □ 1784 did **not** abolish the Company; it split commercial and political functions.

- **Claim:** Crown sovereignty gave a unitary, centrally answerable top. **Evidence:** □ Charter Act **1813** asserted **Crown sovereignty** over Company territories; □ GoI Act **1858** abolished the Company, created the **Viceroy** (Canning) and the **Secretary of State + Council of India**. **Significance:** □□ a centralised administration accountable to a higher political authority — a template the framers democratised. **Caution:** □ the Company was abolished in **1858**, not 1853.

## MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1. Claim:** a single, centralised executive and legislature were built incrementally. **Evidence:** Regulating Act **1773** made the Governor of Bengal the **Governor-General of Bengal** and subordinated Bombay & Madras; Charter Act **1833** created the **Governor-General of India** (first, Bentinck) with sole all-India legislative authority (laws now "Acts"). **Significance:** □□ antecedent of a single Union executive and law-making legislature. **Caution:** the GG of *India* dates from **1833**, not 1773.

**2. Claim:** civilian/political control over the administration predates independence. **Evidence:** Pitt's India Act **1784** created the **Board of Control** → "double government"; Charter Act **1793** entrenched the GG's power to override the council. **Significance:** □□ the principle that administration answers to a political authority foreshadows ministerial responsibility. **Caution:** 1784 did **not** abolish the Company; it split commercial and political functions.

**3. Claim:** Crown sovereignty gave a unitary, centrally answerable top. **Evidence:** Charter Act **1813** asserted **Crown sovereignty** over Company territories; GoI Act **1858** abolished the Company, created the **Viceroy** (Canning) and the **Secretary of State + Council of India**. **Significance:** □□ a centralised administration accountable to a higher political authority — a template the framers democratised. **Caution:** the Company was abolished in **1858**, not 1853.

## MAINS ANGLE

**STUDY LINK**

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.4 Bank A — Centralisation strand (the executive / administrative inheritance)

HIGH

# Foundation · 7.5 Bank B — Representative / devolution strand

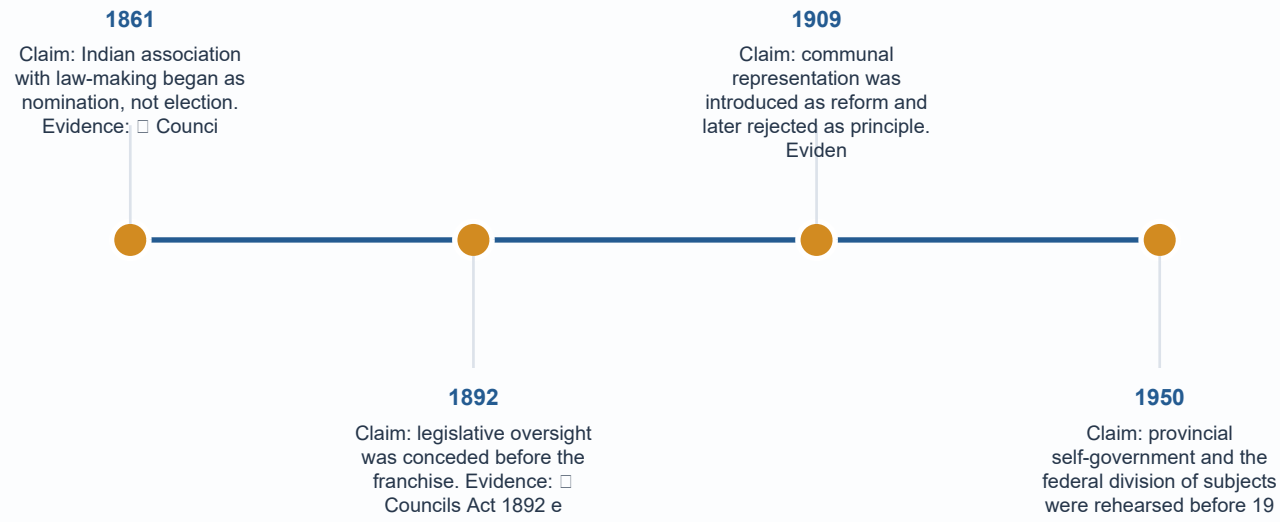
GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

**Claim:** Indian association with law-making began as nomination, not election. **Evidence:** □ Councils Act **1861** added Indian **non-official members** and recognised the **portfolio system** (Canning); restored legislative powers to Bombay & Madras. **Significance:** □□ the portfolio system is the institutional seed of the cabinet/ministerial system; legislative restoration seeds federal devolution. **Caution:** □ members were **nominated**, not elected.

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

## 7.5 BANK B — REPRESENTATIVE / DEVOLUTION STRAND: CHRONOLOGY



## STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** legislative oversight was conceded before the franchise. **Evidence:** □ Councils Act **1892** enlarged councils, allowed **budget discussion** and **questioning of the executive**, and a **limited indirect election** (the word "election" was avoided). **Significance:** □□ budget and question powers are antecedents of parliamentary accountability. **Caution:** □ an official majority was retained — this was not responsible government.

- **Claim:** communal representation was introduced as reform and later rejected as principle. **Evidence:** □ Councils Act **1909** (Morley–Minto) created **separate electorates for Muslims** (Minto = "father of the communal electorate") and enlarged councils; first Indian in the Viceroy's Executive Council = **S.P. Sinha**. **Significance:** □□ this is the feature the Constitution consciously **rejected** — single citizenship, universal adult franchise and (barring temporary SC/ST seat reservation) joint electorates. **Caution:** □ 1909 did **not** introduce dyarchy.

- **Claim:** provincial self-government and the federal division of subjects were rehearsed before 1950. **Evidence:** □ GoI Act **1919** (Montagu–Chelmsford) separated **central and provincial subjects**, introduced **dyarchy** in provinces, **bicameralism** and **direct elections**, and led to the **Central Public Service Commission (1926)**. **Significance:** □□ the split of subjects prefigures the Union/State Lists; the PSC prefigures the UPSC; direct elections prefigure the parliamentary form. **Caution:** □ **provincial autonomy** is **1935**, not 1919 (1919 = dyarchy).

## MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1. Claim:** Indian association with law-making began as nomination, not election. **Evidence:** Councils Act **1861** added Indian **non-official members** and recognised the **portfolio system** (Canning); restored legislative powers to Bombay & Madras. **Significance:** □□ the portfolio system is the institutional seed of the cabinet/ministerial system; legislative restoration seeds federal devolution. **Caution:** members were **nominated**, not elected.

**2. Claim:** legislative oversight was conceded before the franchise. **Evidence:** Councils Act **1892** enlarged councils, allowed **budget discussion** and **questioning of the executive**, and a **limited indirect election** (the word "election" was avoided). **Significance:** □□ budget and question powers are antecedents of parliamentary accountability. **Caution:** an official majority was retained — this was not responsible government.

**3. Claim:** communal representation was introduced as reform and later rejected as principle. **Evidence:** Councils Act **1909** (Morley–Minto) created **separate electorates for Muslims** (Minto = "father of the communal electorate") and enlarged councils; first Indian in the Viceroy's Executive Council = **S.P. Sinha**. **Significance:** □□ this is the feature the Constitution consciously **rejected** — single citizenship, universal adult franchise and (barring temporary SC/ST seat reservation) joint electorates. **Caution:** 1909 did **not** introduce dyarchy.

**4. Claim:** provincial self-government and the federal division of subjects were rehearsed before 1950. **Evidence:** GoI Act **1919** (Montagu–Chelmsford) separated **central and provincial subjects**, introduced **dyarchy** in provinces, **bicameralism** and **direct elections**, and led to the **Central Public Service Commission (1926)**. **Significance:** □□ the split of subjects prefigures the Union/State Lists; the PSC prefigures the UPSC; direct elections prefigure the parliamentary form. **Caution:** **provincial autonomy** is **1935**, not 1919 (1919 = dyarchy).

## MAINS ANGLE

## STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.5 Bank B — Representative / devolution strand

HIGH

# Foundation · 7.6 Bank C — The 1935 and 1947 Acts (the decisive inheritances)

GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

**Claim:** the 1935 Act is the single largest source of the Constitution. **Evidence:** □ it provided an **All-India Federation** (provinces + princely states; never operational), **provincial autonomy**, the three legislative **Lists**, the **Federal Court (1937)**, PSCs, the office of **Governor**, and institutionally the **RBI**; residuary powers to the **Governor-General**. **Significance:** □ the federal scheme, Governor, judiciary, PSCs, emergency provisions and administrative detail passed into 1950 (book: "single largest source"). **Caution:** □ the federation **never came into operation**, and residuary powers went to the **Viceroy**, not the provinces.

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

## STATIC THEORY

- **Claim:** the 1947 Act converted the drafting body into a sovereign constituent power. **Evidence:** □ Indian Independence Act **1947** created two dominions from **15 Aug 1947**, provided for the **lapse of British paramountcy**, and let the Constituent Assembly frame any constitution and repeal British Acts; governance ran on the **GoI Act 1935** until 1950. **Significance:** □□ this is why the Assembly could enact a wholly Indian document and why the princely states had to be integrated. **Caution:** □ paramountcy **lapsed**; it did not automatically pass to India.

## MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1. Claim:** the 1935 Act is the single largest source of the Constitution. **Evidence:** it provided an **All-India Federation** (provinces + princely states; never operational), **provincial autonomy**, the three legislative **Lists**, the **Federal Court (1937)**, PSCs, the office of **Governor**, and institutionally the **RBI**; residuary powers to the **Governor-General**. **Significance:** the federal scheme, Governor, judiciary, PSCs, emergency provisions and administrative detail passed into 1950 (book: "single largest source"). **Caution:** the federation **never came into operation**, and residuary powers went to the **Viceroy**, not the provinces.

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## MAINS ANGLE

## STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.6 Bank C — The 1935 and 1947 Acts (the decisive inheritances)

HIGH

# Foundation · 7.7 Act → 1950 feature it seeded (source-tracing table) · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

### KEY DATA

| Colonial statute | Provision | Feature seeded in 1950 |
|---|---|---|
| □ Regulating Act 1773 | GG of Bengal; Supreme Court, Calcutta | Centralised executive; apex-court idea |
| □ Pitt's India Act 1784 | Board of Control; double govt | Political control over administration |
| □ Charter Act 1833 | GG of India; all-India "Acts" | Single Union legislature / law-making |
| □ Charter Act 1853 | Legislative–executive separation; open competition | Distinct legislature; merit civil service (UPSC lineage) |
| □ GoI Act 1858 | Crown rule; Secretary of State | Centrally answerable executive |
| □ Councils Act 1861 | Portfolio system; Indian non-officials | Cabinet / ministerial system seed |
| □ Councils Act 1892 | Budget discussion; questioning | Legislative oversight / accountability |
| □ Councils Act 1909 | Separate electorates | Feature **rejected** (joint electorate; universal franchise) |

**MAINS ANGLE**

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.7 Act → 1950 feature it seeded (source-tracing table)

HIGH

## Foundation · 7.7 Act → 1950 feature it seeded (source-tracing table) · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

### KEY DATA

| Colonial statute | Provision | Feature seeded in 1950 |
|---|---|---|
| □ GoI Act 1919 | Central/provincial subjects; PSC | Federal division of powers; UPSC |
| □ GoI Act 1935 | Federation, Governor, Federal Court, PSCs, Lists | Federal scheme, judiciary, services (chief source) |
| □ Independence Act 1947 | Sovereign CA; lapse of paramountcy | Autonomous constitution-making; integration |

**MAINS ANGLE**

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.7 Act → 1950 feature it seeded (source-tracing table)

HIGH

## Foundation · 7.7 Act → 1950 feature it seeded (source-tracing table)

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **Analytical use:** this table is the most reusable device for a source-tracing question; it also disciplines a continuity answer by showing both what was inherited and what was refused.

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.7 Act → 1950 feature it seeded (source-tracing table)

HIGH

## Foundation · 7.8 Mechanism, incentives and consequences (how the reforms actually worked)

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Official majorities and a limited franchise** (1892–1935) let councils criticise but not remove the executive → □□ this taught the framers to insist on **responsible government** and universal franchise, not merely enlarged councils.

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### 7.8 MECHANISM, INCENTIVES AND CONSEQUENCES (HOW THE REFORMS ACTUALLY WORKED): RECALL MAP

**7.8 Mechanism, incentives and consequences (how the reforms actually worked)**

V

| | |
|---|---|
| **Dimension 1**<br>□ Official majorities and a limited franchise (1892–1935) let councils criticise but not remove the executive → □□ this taught the framers to insist o | **Dimension 2**<br>□ Separate electorates (1909; extended 1919 to Sikhs, Christians, Anglo-Indians, Europeans; Communal Award 1932 to depressed classes) → □□ institution |
| **Dimension 3**<br>□ Dyarchy (1919 provinces; 1935 at the Centre, never operational) split responsibility between ministers and the Governor → □□ its friction discredite | |

### STATIC THEORY

- □ **Separate electorates** (1909; extended 1919 to Sikhs, Christians, Anglo-Indians, Europeans; **Communal Award 1932** to depressed classes) → □□ institutionalised community-based mobilisation; the □ **Poona Pact (1932)** substituted reserved seats within a joint electorate — the model the Constitution adopted for SC/ST.

- □ **Dyarchy** (1919 provinces; 1935 at the Centre, never operational) split responsibility between ministers and the Governor → □□ its friction discredited divided responsibility and pushed the framers toward **full provincial autonomy** and collective ministerial responsibility.

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1. Official majorities and a limited franchise** (1892–1935) let councils criticise but not remove the executive → □□ this taught the framers to insist on **responsible government** and universal franchise, not merely enlarged councils.

**2. Separate electorates** (1909; extended 1919 to Sikhs, Christians, Anglo-Indians, Europeans; **Communal Award 1932** to depressed classes) → □□ institutionalised community-based mobilisation; the **Poona Pact (1932)** substituted reserved seats within a joint electorate — the model the Constitution adopted for SC/ST.

**3. Dyarchy** (1919 provinces; 1935 at the Centre, never operational) split responsibility between ministers and the Governor → □□ its friction discredited divided responsibility and pushed the framers toward **full provincial autonomy** and collective ministerial responsibility.

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.8 Mechanism, incentives and consequences (how the reforms actually worked)

HIGH

## Foundation · 7.9 Criticism, counter-argument and variation

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **"The Constitution is a mere colonial continuation"** overstates: universal adult franchise, justiciable Fundamental Rights, an independent Election Commission and single citizenship have **no colonial parent**.

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### 7.9 CRITICISM, COUNTER-ARGUMENT AND VARIATION: RECALL MAP

**7.9 Criticism, counter-argument and variation**

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| | |
|---|---|
| **Dimension 1**<br>□□ "The Constitution is a mere colonial continuation" overstates: universal adult franchise, justiciable Fundamental Rights, an independent Election C | **Dimension 2**<br>□□ "It is wholly original" also fails: the Constitution retained substantial administrative detail and institutional architecture from the 1935 Act, w |
| **Dimension 3**<br>□□ Temporal variation: the centralising Acts (1773–1858) and the devolving Acts (1861–1935) pull in opposite directions; an answer that cites only one | |

### STATIC THEORY

- □□ **"It is wholly original"** also fails: the Constitution retained substantial administrative detail and institutional architecture from the 1935 Act, while the parliamentary form drew on Westminster practice.

- □□ **Temporal variation:** the centralising Acts (1773–1858) and the devolving Acts (1861–1935) pull in opposite directions; an answer that cites only one strand misreads the inheritance.

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.9 Criticism, counter-argument and variation

HIGH

# Foundation · 7.10 Verdict scaffolds

GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

**Culmination verdict:** "The Constitution is the culmination of colonial constitutional development in its structure and the repudiation of it in its politics — inheriting the 1935 federal-administrative frame while discarding official majorities, separate electorates and a restricted franchise."

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### 7.10 VERDICT SCAFFOLDS: RECALL MAP

**7.10 Verdict scaffolds**

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| | |
|---|---|
| **Dimension 1**<br>Culmination verdict: "The Constitution is the culmination of colonial constitutional development in its structure and the repudiation of it in its pol | **Dimension 2**<br>Source-tracing verdict: "No single Act 'made' the Constitution, but the 1935 Act came closest; the rest supplied the incremental machinery of a centra |
| **Dimension 3**<br>Representative-evolution verdict: "Representation advanced from nomination (1861) to consultation (1892) to communal election (1909) to provincial sel | |

## STATIC THEORY

- **Source-tracing verdict:** "No single Act 'made' the Constitution, but the 1935 Act came closest; the rest supplied the incremental machinery of a centralised state and a slowly widening representation."

- **Representative-evolution verdict:** "Representation advanced from nomination (1861) to consultation (1892) to communal election (1909) to provincial self-rule (1935) — a graded ascent the Constitution completed by grounding power in universal adult franchise."

## MAINS ANGLE

**STUDY LINK**

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.10 Verdict scaffolds

HIGH

# Foundation · 7.11 Prelims close-option distinctions

GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

**Routed 2024 Prelims GS-I Q62 — GoI Act 1935, All-India Federation and reserved control of defence/foreign affairs:**  the Act **provided for** an All-India Federation of provinces and princely states (that statement is correct **even though the federation never operated**, because the requisite princely states did not accede);  **defence and external/foreign affairs were "reserved" subjects administered by the Governor-General**, not placed under the federal legislature. A statement claiming the federal legislature controlled defence/foreign affairs is therefore **wrong**.

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

## 7.11 PRELIMS CLOSE-OPTION DISTINCTIONS: RECALL MAP

**7.11 Prelims close-option distinctions**

V

| | |
|---|---|
| **Dimension 1**<br>Routed 2024 Prelims GS-I Q62 — GoI Act 1935, All-India Federation and reserved control of defence/foreign affairs: □ the Act provided for an All-India | **Dimension 2**<br>1773 vs 1833: GG of Bengal (1773) vs GG of India (1833). |
| **Dimension 3**<br>1853 vs 1858: 1853 separated the council's legislative and executive functions; the Company was abolished in 1858. | **Dimension 4**<br>1909 vs 1919 vs 1935: communal electorate (1909) · dyarchy in provinces (1919) · provincial autonomy (1935). Never swap these. |

### STATIC THEORY

- **1773 vs 1833:** GG of **Bengal** (1773) vs GG of **India** (1833).

- **1853 vs 1858:** 1853 separated the council's legislative and executive functions; the Company was **abolished in 1858**.

- **1909 vs 1919 vs 1935:** communal electorate (1909) · dyarchy in provinces (1919) · provincial autonomy (1935). Never swap these.

- **Residuary powers under 1935:** vested in the **Viceroy / Governor-General**, not the provinces.

- **First Indian on the Viceroy's Executive Council: S.P. Sinha (1909)**, not 1919.

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1. Routed 2024 Prelims GS-I Q62 — GoI Act 1935, All-India Federation and reserved control of defence/foreign affairs:** the Act **provided for** an All-India Federation of provinces and princely states (that statement is correct **even though the federation never operated**, because the requisite princely states did not accede); **defence and external/foreign affairs were "reserved" subjects administered by the Governor-General**, not placed under the federal legislature. A statement claiming the federal legislature controlled defence/foreign affairs is therefore **wrong**.

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.11 Prelims close-option distinctions

HIGH

# Foundation · 7.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

GS-II Indian Polity

### NEWS TRIGGER

Do **not** state that the Regulating Act 1773 created the Governor-General of **India** — it created the GG of **Bengal**. Do **not** state that the 1935 federation came into operation — □ it **never** did. Do **not** assign residuary powers under the 1935 Act to the provinces — □ they went to the **Governor-General**.

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Do **not** describe 1909 as introducing dyarchy, or 1919 as introducing provincial autonomy.

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

## 7.12 FACTUAL-RISK AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROLS: RECALL MAP

**7.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls**

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| | |
|---|---|
| **Dimension 1**<br>Do not describe 1909 as introducing dyarchy, or 1919 as introducing provincial autonomy. | **Dimension 2**<br>Do not claim the Constitution "borrowed" separate electorates — □ it rejected them (single citizenship; universal adult franchise). |
| **Dimension 3**<br>This is a static chapter: do not attach any post-2019 "current status" to these colonial Acts. | **Dimension 4**<br>less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -→ |

### STATIC THEORY

- Do **not** claim the Constitution "borrowed" separate electorates — □ it **rejected** them (single citizenship; universal adult franchise).

- This is a **static** chapter: do not attach any post-2019 "current status" to these colonial Acts.

- less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -→

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1.** Do **not** claim the Constitution "borrowed" separate electorates — it **rejected** them (single citizenship; universal adult franchise).

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

HIGH

## Foundation · Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

**GS-II** Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

### KEY DATA

| Year | Paper | Q | PYQ demand (neutral rendering) | Directive / format | Source status | Owner requirement |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2024 | Prelims GS-I | 62 | Government of India Act, 1935 - All-India Federation and reserved control of defence and foreign affairs | Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred | Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here | Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions. |

**MAINS ANGLE**

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

HIGH

## Foundation · Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025).

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

**MAINS ANGLE**

***Status:*** *2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner.* ***Provenance:*** *Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md.* ***Answer-key rule:*** *The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.* ***Years represented:*** *2024* ***Paper(s):*** *Prelims GS-I* ***Routed question demands:*** *1*

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

HIGH

## Foundation · What this owner must now support

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Government of India Act, 1935 - All-India Federation and reserved control of defence and foreign affairs

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### WHAT THIS OWNER MUST NOW SUPPORT: RECALL MAP

**What this owner must now support**

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| | |
|---|---|
| **Dimension 1**<br>Government of India Act, 1935 - All-India Federation and reserved control of defence and foreign affairs | **Dimension 2**<br>This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed |
| **Dimension 3**<br>less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -→ | |

### STATIC THEORY

- This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

- less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -→

**MAINS ANGLE**

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

HIGH

# Foundation · Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control.

*Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

## MAINS ANGLE

***Official syllabus/index and owned core:*** *constitutional development from the Regulating Act 1773 to the Indian Independence Act 1947, arranged by control, centralisation, representation, responsibility, federal design and transfer of constituent sovereignty.* ***Exact chronology:*** *1773 GG of Bengal and Calcutta Supreme Court; 1781 jurisdictional settlement; 1784 Board of Control; 1813/1833/1853 Charter transitions; 1858 Crown rule; 1861 association; 1892 scrutiny; 1909 separate Muslim electorates; 1919 provincial dyarchy and central bicameralism; 1935 provincial autonomy and an uncommenced federation; 1947 dominion independence.* ***Institutional mechanism:*** *trace Parliament/Crown, Court of Directors, Board of Control, Secretary of State, Governor-General/Viceroy, councils, ministers, legislatures, Federal Court, public-service commissions and lists.* ***1935 precision:*** *proposed federation, provincial autonomy, proposed central dyarchy, Federal/Provincial/Concurrent Lists, Governor-General residuary allocation, safeguards and discretionary powers; do not say the federation or central dyarchy commenced.* ***Continuity and rupture:*** *the Constitution retained administrative, judicial, service and federal machinery but rejected imperial sovereignty, official majorities, communal electorates and restricted franchise through popular sovereignty, rights, review and universal adult suffrage.* ***Boundary:*** *Topic 02 owns the Constituent Assembly's detailed composition and drafting; Modern History owns nationalist movements and Partition; Salient Features owns comparative constitutional borrowing.*
***Four-ledger hostile audit:*** *literal syllabus, indispensable constitutional chronology, standard textbook Act taxonomy and every routed 2018-2026 demand were checked for dates, offices, commencement, exceptions and causal overreach.* ***Verified PYQ ownership, 2018-2026:*** *the direct route is 2024 Prelims GS-I Q62 on the 1935 federation and reserved defence/external-affairs control. No other direct route is fabricated; adjacent reform demands retain their catalogue owners and no unavailable answer key is promoted.* ***Source hierarchy:*** *official constitutional/statutory text first, then authoritative institutional records, reported judgments, Constituent Assembly materials and standard textbooks; static colonial history is not refreshed through unsourced current-affairs claims.*

## STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

HIGH

# Advanced · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

**Subject:** Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-I (Modern History) & GS-II

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

## CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

**Core Foundation**

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| | |
|---|---|
| **Dimension 1**<br>Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) · GS Paper: GS-I (Modern History) & GS-II | **Dimension 2**<br>Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 1 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF). |
| **Dimension 3**<br>□ = from source book · □□ = inference. (Low direct CA; static high-frequency chapter.) | **Dimension 4**<br>Companion: basic/Historical-Background.md. |

## STATIC THEORY

- **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 1 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).

- □ = from source book · □□ = inference. *(Low direct CA; static high-frequency chapter.)*

- *Companion: basic/Historical-Background.md.*

## MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1.** = from source book · □□ = inference. *(Low direct CA; static high-frequency chapter.)*

## MAINS ANGLE

## STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

# Advanced · Frame

GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

□ British came **1600** as East India Company (charter of **Queen Elizabeth I**). **1765** — Company got **Diwani** (revenue + civil justice) of Bengal, Bihar, Orissa → became a **territorial power**. **1858** — after the sepoy mutiny, Crown took direct control. **15 Aug 1947** — independence. Two phases: **Company Rule (1773–1858)** and **Crown Rule (1858–1947)**.

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1.** British came **1600** as East India Company (charter of **Queen Elizabeth I**). **1765** — Company got **Diwani** (revenue + civil justice) of Bengal, Bihar, Orissa → became a **territorial power**. **1858** — after the sepoy mutiny, Crown took direct control. **15 Aug 1947** — independence. Two phases: **Company Rule (1773–1858)** and **Crown Rule (1858–1947)**.

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Frame

HIGH

## Advanced · PART A — COMPANY RULE (1773–1858)

**GS-II** Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of PART A — COMPANY RULE (1773–1858).

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A — COMPANY RULE (1773–1858)

HIGH

## Advanced · Regulating Act, 1773 □ (first step to regulate the Company)

**GS-II** Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

□ (1) **Governor of Bengal** → **"Governor-General of Bengal"** + 4-member Executive Council; first = **Warren Hastings**. (2) Bombay & Madras governors made **subordinate** to GG Bengal. (3) **Supreme Court at Calcutta (1774)** — 1 CJ + 3 judges. (4) Barred Company servants from private trade/bribes. (5) Court of Directors to report on revenue/civil/military affairs. → *foundations of central admin.*

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1.** (1) **Governor of Bengal** → **"Governor-General of Bengal"** + 4-member Executive Council; first = **Warren Hastings**. (2) Bombay & Madras governors made **subordinate** to GG Bengal. (3) **Supreme Court at Calcutta (1774)** — 1 CJ + 3 judges. (4) Barred Company servants from private trade/bribes. (5) Court of Directors to report on revenue/civil/military affairs. → *foundations of central admin.*

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Regulating Act, 1773 □ (first step to regulate the Company)

HIGH

## Advanced · Amending Act (Act of Settlement), 1781

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

 Exempted GG-Council & Company servants from Supreme Court jurisdiction for official acts; excluded revenue matters; SC jurisdiction over Calcutta inhabitants w/ **personal law** (Hindu/Muslim); appeals from Provincial Courts → GG-in-Council.

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1.** Exempted GG-Council & Company servants from Supreme Court jurisdiction for official acts; excluded revenue matters; SC jurisdiction over Calcutta inhabitants w/ **personal law** (Hindu/Muslim); appeals from Provincial Courts → GG-in-Council.

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Amending Act (Act of Settlement), 1781

HIGH

## Advanced · Pitt's India Act, 1784 

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

 Distinguished **commercial vs political** functions; Court of Directors (commerce) + new **Board of Control** (politics) → **double government**. First time Company territories called **"British possessions in India."** British Govt got **supreme control**.

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1.** Distinguished **commercial vs political** functions; Court of Directors (commerce) + new **Board of Control** (politics) → **double government**. First time Company territories called **"British possessions in India."** British Govt got **supreme control**.

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Pitt's India Act, 1784 

HIGH

## Advanced · Act of 1786

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

 **Lord Cornwallis** made GG with power to **override his council** + made **Commander-in-Chief**.

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1. Lord Cornwallis** made GG with power to **override his council** + made **Commander-in-Chief**.

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Act of 1786

HIGH

## Advanced · Charter Act, 1793

**GS-II** Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

 Extended override power to all future GGs/Governors; Board of Control staff paid from **Indian revenues**; extended Company trade monopoly 20 more years.

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1.** Extended override power to all future GGs/Governors; Board of Control staff paid from **Indian revenues**; extended Company trade monopoly 20 more years.

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Charter Act, 1793

HIGH

## Advanced · Charter Act, 1813

**GS-II** Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

 **Abolished Company's trade monopoly** (open to all British merchants) — **except tea & China trade**; asserted **Crown sovereignty** over Company territories; allowed **Christian missionaries**; earmarked at least **one lakh rupees annually** for literature, learned Indians and the promotion of scientific knowledge (not an express statutory choice of English or "Western education"); local governments could impose taxes.

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1. Abolished Company's trade monopoly** (open to all British merchants) — **except tea & China trade**; asserted **Crown sovereignty** over Company territories; allowed **Christian missionaries**; earmarked at least **one lakh rupees annually** for literature, learned Indians and the promotion of scientific knowledge (not an express statutory choice of English or "Western education"); local governments could impose taxes.

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Charter Act, 1813

HIGH

## Advanced · Charter Act, 1833 □ (final step of centralisation)

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **GG of Bengal → GG of India** with all civil/military powers; first = **Lord William Bentinck**. Created **Govt of India** over all British India. Bombay/Madras **lost legislative powers** (laws now "**Acts**," earlier "Regulations"). Company became a **purely administrative** body (territories held "in trust for His Majesty"). Attempted **open competition** for civil services (**negated** by Court of Directors' opposition).

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1. GG of Bengal → GG of India** with all civil/military powers; first = **Lord William Bentinck**. Created **Govt of India** over all British India. Bombay/Madras **lost legislative powers** (laws now "**Acts**," earlier "Regulations"). Company became a **purely administrative** body (territories held "in trust for His Majesty"). Attempted **open competition** for civil services (**negated** by Court of Directors' opposition).

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Charter Act, 1833 □ (final step of centralisation)

HIGH

## Advanced · Charter Act, 1853 □ (last Charter Act)

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Separated legislative & executive** functions of GG's council; +6 legislative councillors → **Indian (Central) Legislative Council** ("mini-Parliament"). Introduced **open competition** for civil service (open to Indians) → **Macaulay Committee, 1854**. Company rule extended with **no fixed term** (Parliament could end anytime). First **local representation** (4 of 6 members from Madras, Bombay, Bengal, Agra).

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1. Separated legislative & executive** functions of GG's council; +6 legislative councillors → **Indian (Central) Legislative Council** ("mini-Parliament"). Introduced **open competition** for civil service (open to Indians) → **Macaulay Committee, 1854**. Company rule extended with **no fixed term** (Parliament could end anytime). First **local representation** (4 of 6 members from Madras, Bombay, Bengal, Agra).

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Charter Act, 1853 □ (last Charter Act)

HIGH

## Advanced · PART B — CROWN RULE (1858–1947)

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of PART B — CROWN RULE (1858–1947).

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART B — CROWN RULE (1858–1947)

HIGH

## Advanced · Government of India Act, 1858 □ ("Act for Good Government of India")

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Enacted after **Revolt of 1857**. **Abolished East India Company**; power to **British Crown**. **GG of India → Viceroy** (direct Crown representative); first = **Lord Canning**. Ended **double govt** (abolished Board of Control + Court of Directors). Created **Secretary of State for India** (British Cabinet member) + **15-member Council of India** (advisory).

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1.** Enacted after **Revolt of 1857**. **Abolished East India Company**; power to **British Crown**. **GG of India → Viceroy** (direct Crown representative); first = **Lord Canning**. Ended **double govt** (abolished Board of Control + Court of Directors). Created **Secretary of State for India** (British Cabinet member) + **15-member Council of India** (advisory).

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Government of India Act, 1858 □ ("Act for Good Government of India")

HIGH

## Advanced · Indian Councils Act, 1861 □

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Began **representative institutions** — Indians as non-official members (1862: Canning nominated Raja of Benaras, Maharaja of Patiala, Sir Dinkar Rao). **Decentralisation** — restored legislative powers to Bombay & Madras. New councils for Bengal/NWP/Punjab (1862/1886/1897). Recognised **portfolio system** (Canning, 1859). Viceroy could issue **ordinances** (6-month life).

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1.** Began **representative institutions** — Indians as non-official members (1862: Canning nominated Raja of Benaras, Maharaja of Patiala, Sir Dinkar Rao). **Decentralisation** — restored legislative powers to Bombay & Madras. New councils for Bengal/NWP/Punjab (1862/1886/1897). Recognised **portfolio system** (Canning, 1859). Viceroy could issue **ordinances** (6-month life).

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Indian Councils Act, 1861 □

HIGH

## Advanced · Indian Councils Act, 1892

**GS-II** Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Increased non-official members (official majority retained); councils got power to **discuss budget** & question executive; **limited indirect election** (word "election" not used — described as "nomination on recommendation").

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1.** Increased non-official members (official majority retained); councils got power to **discuss budget** & question executive; **limited indirect election** (word "election" not used — described as "nomination on recommendation").

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Indian Councils Act, 1892

HIGH

## Advanced · Indian Councils Act, 1909 □ (Morley–Minto Reforms)

**GS-II** Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Central council raised **16 → 60**; official majority retained at Centre, non-official majority in provinces. **First Indian in Viceroy's executive council = Satyendra Prasad Sinha (Law Member)**. Introduced **separate electorate for Muslims** — "legalised communalism"; **Lord Minto = Father of Communal Electorate**.

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## MAINS ANGLE

## STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Indian Councils Act, 1909 □ (Morley–Minto Reforms)

HIGH

# Advanced · Government of India Act, 1919 □ (Montagu–Chelmsford; in force 1921)

GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

□ (1) Separated **central & provincial subjects** (still unitary structure). (2) Provincial subjects split into **transferred** (Governor + responsible ministers) & **reserved** (Governor + executive council) = **DYARCHY** (Greek *di-arche*, double rule); largely a failure. (3) First **bicameralism** & **direct elections** — Council of State (upper) + Legislative Assembly (lower). (4) 3 of 6 Viceroy's council members to be **Indian**. (5) Separate electorates extended to **Sikhs, Christians, Anglo-Indians, Europeans**. (6) Limited franchise (property/tax/education). (7) **High Commissioner for India** in London. (8) **Central Public Service Commission (1926)**. (9) Separated provincial budgets. (10) Provided **statutory commission after 10 years** → Simon Commission.

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

## GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ACT, 1919 □ (MONTAGU–CHELMSFORD; IN FORCE 1921): RECALL MAP

**Government of India Act, 1919 □ (Montagu–Chelmsford; in force 1921)**

V

| | |
|---|---|
| **Dimension 1**<br>□ (1) Separated central & provincial subjects (still unitary structure). (2) Provincial subjects split into transferred (Governor + responsible minist | **Dimension 2**<br>Simon Commission (1927): □ 7 members, all British → boycotted. Report (1930): abolish dyarchy, responsible govt in provinces, federation of British In |
| **Dimension 3**<br>Communal Award (1932): □ Ramsay MacDonald — separate electorates extended to depressed classes (SCs). Gandhi's fast unto death (Yerawada Jail) → Poona | |

## STATIC THEORY

- **Simon Commission (1927):** □ 7 members, **all British** → boycotted. Report (1930): abolish dyarchy, responsible govt in provinces, federation of British India + princely states. Led to **3 Round Table Conferences** → **White Paper** → Joint Select Committee → **GoI Act 1935**.

- **Communal Award (1932):** □ Ramsay MacDonald — separate electorates extended to **depressed classes (SCs)**. Gandhi's **fast unto death** (Yerawada Jail) → **Poona Pact** — retained Hindu joint electorate + reserved seats for depressed classes.

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### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Government of India Act, 1919 □ (Montagu–Chelmsford; in force 1921)

HIGH

## Advanced · Government of India Act, 1935 □□ (321 Sections, 10 Schedules)

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

□ (1) **All-India Federation** (provinces + princely states); powers split into **Federal (59), Provincial (54), Concurrent (36)** lists; residuary to **Viceroy** — **federation never formed** (princely states didn't join). (2) Abolished provincial dyarchy → **provincial autonomy** (responsible govt; 1937–39). (3) **Dyarchy at Centre** (never operational). (4) Bicameralism in **6 of 11 provinces** (Bengal, Bombay, Madras, Bihar, Assam, UP). (5) Separate electorates extended to **depressed classes, women, labour**. (6) Abolished **Council of India**. (7) Franchise **~10%**. (8) **Reserve Bank of India**. (9) Federal + Provincial + Joint **PSCs**. (10) **Federal Court (1937)**.

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

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### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Government of India Act, 1935 □□ (321 Sections, 10 Schedules)

HIGH

# Advanced · Indian Independence Act, 1947 □

GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Clement Attlee (20 Feb 1947): British rule to end by **30 Jun 1948**. **Mountbatten Plan (3 Jun 1947)** → Act. Features: (1) ended British rule, India independent & sovereign from **15 Aug 1947**; (2) **partition** → two dominions (India & Pakistan) with right to secede from Commonwealth; (3) abolished **Viceroy** → each dominion a **Governor-General**; (4) Constituent Assemblies could frame any constitution & repeal British Acts; (5) legislate till new constitutions; (6) abolished **Secretary of State for India**; (7) **lapse of British paramountcy** over princely states and related Crown treaty obligations; (8) accession was therefore not automatic absorption into either Dominion and had to be secured through Indian political and legal action; (9) governance via **GoI Act 1935** till new constitution; (10)–(11) GG & governors became **constitutional (nominal) heads** on ministers' advice; (12) dropped **"Emperor of India"** title.

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

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## MAINS ANGLE

## STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Indian Independence Act, 1947 □

HIGH

# Advanced · Quick "FIRSTS" table (Prelims gold) · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

## KEY DATA

| First | Act |
|---|---|
| □ Governor-General of Bengal (Warren Hastings) | Regulating Act 1773 |
| □ Supreme Court (Calcutta) | Regulating Act 1773 |
| □ Board of Control / double govt | Pitt's India Act 1784 |
| □ Governor-General of India (William Bentinck) | Charter Act 1833 |
| □ Separation of legislative & executive; open competition CS | Charter Act 1853 |
| □ Viceroy (Lord Canning); Secretary of State | GoI Act 1858 |
| □ Portfolio system recognised; Indians in law-making | Councils Act 1861 |
| □ Separate electorate for Muslims (Minto) | Councils Act 1909 |

**MAINS ANGLE**

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Quick "FIRSTS" table (Prelims gold)

HIGH

## Advanced · Quick "FIRSTS" table (Prelims gold) · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

### KEY DATA

| First | Act |
|---|---|
| □ First Indian in Viceroy's Exec Council (S.P. Sinha) | Councils Act 1909 |
| □ Dyarchy in provinces; bicameralism; direct election | GoI Act 1919 |
| □ Provincial autonomy; RBI; Federal Court | GoI Act 1935 |

**MAINS ANGLE**

**STUDY LINK**
Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Quick "FIRSTS" table (Prelims gold)

HIGH

## Advanced · UPSC Traps

GS-II Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of UPSC Traps.

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

## UPSC TRAPS

**WRONG:** Regulating Act created GG of **India**

**CORRECT:** GG of **Bengal**; GG of India came with **Charter Act 1833**.

**WRONG:** 1853 abolished Company

**CORRECT:** Company abolished by **GoI Act 1858**.

**WRONG:** Morley-Minto (1909) introduced dyarchy

**CORRECT:** dyarchy = **1919**; 1909 = communal electorate.

**WRONG:** 1919 introduced provincial autonomy

**CORRECT:** that's **1935**; 1919 = dyarchy.

**WRONG:** Residuary powers under 1935 went to provinces

**CORRECT:** to the **Viceroy**.

**WRONG:** 1935 federation actually functioned

**CORRECT:** **never formed** (princely states stayed out).

**WRONG:** First Indian on Viceroy's council under 1919

**CORRECT:** **S.P. Sinha under 1909**.

## MAINS ANGLE

## STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH

# Advanced · Why it matters / relevance

**GS-II** Indian Polity

## INTRO & ORIGIN

 **GoI Act 1935 is the single largest source** of the present Constitution (federal scheme, office

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

## WHY IT MATTERS / RELEVANCE: RECALL MAP

**Why it matters / relevance**

V

**Dimension 1**
 GoI Act 1935 is the single largest source of the present Constitution (federal scheme, office

**Dimension 2**
of Governor, judiciary, PSCs, administrative detail) — links to 03Salient-Features "Sources."

**Dimension 3**
 Recurring debates on "colonial-era laws" (IPC→BNS, sedition, preventive detention) trace their

**Dimension 4**
lineage here — useful Mains framing on decolonising the statute book.

### STATIC THEORY

- of Governor, judiciary, PSCs, administrative detail) — links to 03_Salient-Features "Sources."

- □□ Recurring debates on "colonial-era laws" (IPC→BNS, sedition, preventive detention) trace their

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### MUST-KNOW FACTS

**1. GoI Act 1935 is the single largest source** of the present Constitution (federal scheme, office

### MAINS ANGLE

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Why it matters / relevance

HIGH

## Advanced · Mains angles

**GS-II** Indian Polity

### INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

*Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

### MAINS ANGLE

*"The Indian Constitution is a natural culmination of the constitutional developments under British rule." Examine. Evolution of representative institutions & the seeds of communalism (1892 → 1909 → 1932).*

### STUDY LINK

Historical Background of the Constitution (1773–1947) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI